The assertion escapes are as follows:

Table 8-28. *PCRE assertion escape sequences*

\b	Word boundary
\B	Not a word boundary
\A	The very start of the sample (not multiline)
\Z	The very end of the sample (not multiline)
\z	End of subject
\G	First matching position of subject

On first glance most of these probably seem straightforward, but there's some subtle logic at play. Here are some examples to illustrate, and we're going to use an additional feature of `preg_match_all()` by passing in an array as the third argument. This array is passed by reference by default and will have each matching part of the sample added to it, enabling a detailed inspection of the results.

```
$text = '... I found a human foot ...';
preg_match_all('/\w/', $text, $matches);
var_dump($matches[0]);
```

```
Output:
Array
(
    [0] => I
    [1] => f
    [2] => o
    [3] => u
    [4] => n
    ...
```

So far so good, `\w` matches with all sixteen alphanumeric characters in the sample. We can see each element of the `$matches` array contains the non-punctuation, non-space portions of `$text`: `I`, `f`, `o`, `u`, etc. The non-consumption/zero-width matching is irrelevant here, the PCRE engine moves on after each match regardless. The next example should make this point clearer: